

The world in brief

Catch up quickly on the global stories that matter



Photograph: AFP via Getty Images

America and **Iran** reached an agreement over their war. Details are sketchy, however. Donald Trump said the deal would extend a ceasefire, restore shipping through the Strait of Hormuz and that America would lift its blockade of Iranian ports. Iran said the agreement, which it claimed would include Lebanon, would be signed in Geneva on Friday. The preliminary deal could pave the way for talks addressing Iran's nuclear programme and ultimately ending the war permanently.

Asian **stocks** rocketed when markets opened, while the price of Brent crude, the global **oil** benchmark, fell by 4%, to around \$83 per barrel. Several world leaders welcomed the agreement. Some American lawmakers expressed scepticism. Lindsey Graham, a Republican senator, said he was "somewhat concerned that Iran's view of the agreement seems different than what the American negotiating team is claiming".

Mr Trump spoke separately with **Vladimir Putin** and **Volodymyr Zelensky**. Ukraine's president said he would meet his American counterpart at this week's G7 summit in France. According to the Kremlin, Mr Trump told Mr Putin that he was ready to work with [Ukraine](#) and America's European allies to secure a ceasefire.

Meanwhile Russia launched air attacks on Kyiv, injuring 20 people and causing a blaze at a monastery.

The **European Commission** said it was assessing the consequences of [an American order](#) that prompted **Anthropic**, an artificial-intelligence company, to restrict access to its most advanced models. The company said it would disable Fable 5 and Mythos 5 after the Trump administration barred foreign nationals, including [Anthropic's](#) own foreign employees, from using them. A commission spokesman said the dispute highlighted the need for Europe to strengthen its tech sovereignty.

Swiss voters rejected, by nearly 55% to 45%, a [proposal](#) to cap the country's population at 10m. The defeat is a blow to the anti-immigration Swiss People's Party. The initiative would have obliged the government to curb population growth and could ultimately have jeopardised Switzerland's free-movement agreement with the ^{EU}. Opponents argued it would worsen labour shortages and harm the economy.

British armed forces seized a tanker carrying roughly 700,000 barrels of **Russian oil** in the English Channel. It is their first operation against Russia's [shadow fleet](#). Officers from the National Crime Agency arrested an Indian national on suspicion of sanctions offences. Sir Keir Starmer, Britain's prime minister, said the move reminded "those fuelling Putin's war in Ukraine that we will not let them hide."

Mr Trump marked his 80th birthday with a mixed-martial-arts event at the White House, hosted by the **Ultimate Fighting Championship**. The spectacle underscored the long relationship between the octogenarian and [Dana White](#), the ^{UFC}'s boss, whose support helped the president court young male voters. The festivities also included a \$1m-a-head fundraiser for a pro-Trump political action committee at the president's Virginia golf club.

Figure of the day: 13.2 months. The median survival times for patients with pancreatic cancer who tried a new drug—double what it is now. Read about the medical [breakthrough](#).



Photograph: AP

France seeks unity on Ukraine at the G7

World leaders arrive on Monday in the French lakeside town of Evian-les-Bains for a G7 summit that runs until Wednesday. Barring a last-minute change of plans, Donald Trump is expected to attend. The next day President Emmanuel Macron will host other gatherings that include the leaders of Brazil, Egypt, India, Kenya, South Korea and Ukraine.

The official agenda focuses on global economic imbalances and ways to support growth. Yet discussions will probably be dominated by geopolitics, including the [war in Ukraine](#), the crisis in the Strait of Hormuz and relations with the global south. France wants to keep America engaged in Ukraine and discuss conditions for direct talks between Russia and Ukraine. It also hopes to revive plans for a “coalition of the willing” to patrol the strait once hostilities subside. Much will depend on Mr Trump’s attitude. Last year he left the G7 in Canada early. On Wednesday evening Mr Macron is laying on a banquet for him at the Palace of Versailles, which should help keep him around until the end.



Photograph: Getty Images

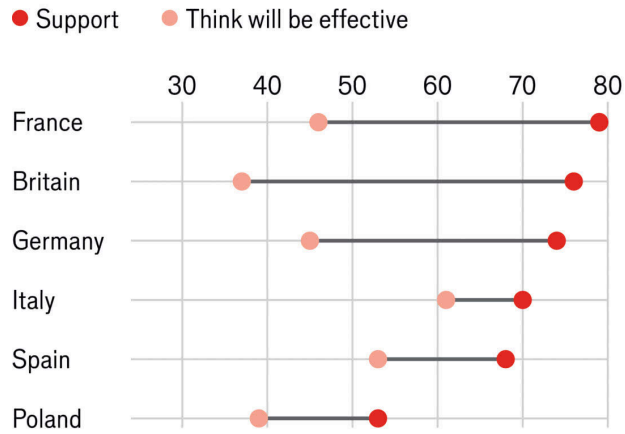
Britain moves closer to a social-media ban

This week the British government is expected to publish its [response](#) to a consultation on “growing up in the online world”, following which it may ban under-16s from social media. The move would follow similar efforts in Australia and come amid growing support for tough online-safety rules.

Sir Keir Starmer, Britain’s beleaguered prime minister, faces a leadership challenge, possibly as soon as this month. He wants to demonstrate he can take action on issues that voters care about. Supporters argue that social media exposes children to harmful content and makes them miserable. Critics counter that restrictions are easy to circumvent and do little to prevent access to the most dangerous material. The debate reflects a broader tension in government policy: ambitions to make Britain an AI powerhouse mix with a growing appetite for regulating big tech.

Fans of bans

Attitudes among adults towards a social-media ban for children*, March 2026, % responding



Source: YouGov

*Aged under 16



Photograph: AFP via Getty Images

Myanmar's strongman takes a victory lap in Beijing

Min Aung Hlaing, Myanmar's president, is on a roll. The general who seized power in a coup in 2021 was appointed head of state in April by a parliament packed with representatives elected in a [widely criticised poll](#) held in December and January. After walking one set of red carpets in India two weeks ago, he will arrive in China on Monday for talks with Xi Jinping.

He arrives with signs of momentum at home. His regime has recently regained ground against armed resistance groups after years of setbacks. He is likely to thank China for its considerable support and seek further investment, including for the revival of the controversial Myitsone dam project, which a previous civilian government suspended in 2011. China also announced on Friday the arrest on espionage charges of Min Zin, a Myanmar-born American analyst and prominent critic of the regime.



Photograph: Reuters

America's biggest wind farm powers up

America's largest renewables installation could begin commercial operations as early as Monday. Since April a 3.5-gigawatt wind farm in New Mexico has been quietly ramping up generation and delivering electricity to the grid during testing. The SunZia project connects more than 900 turbines to Arizona and California via a 550-mile (885-km) cable. Capable of powering a million homes, it is three times the size of its nearest rival.

First proposed in 2006, SunZia took two decades of planning and fighting over permits. Yet its launch is attracting little fanfare. That reflects an increasingly hostile political climate. Donald Trump has scrapped tax credits and frozen federal approvals for some renewable-energy projects, stalling billions of dollars of investment. Wood Mackenzie, a research firm, reckons wind installations in America could fall by 17% by 2030. Even so, California has broken its wind-generation record at least five times in recent months. The president cannot completely control the way the wind is blowing.



Illustration: Sandra Navarro

Daily quiz

We will serve you a new question each weekday. On Friday your challenge is to give us all five answers and tell us the theme. Email your responses (and your home city and country) by 1700 GMT on Friday to [\[email protected\]](#). We'll pick three winners at random and crown them on Saturday.

Monday: *La vache qui rit* is a French cheese brand featuring which animal?

*You do not change people's minds
by defeating them with logic.*

Herbert A. Simon